



Diet guide for Indians

Published by the National Institute of Nutrition, this manual keeps local food habits in focus. <https://dgit.in/jan20-31>



Problems with nutritional science

An exploration of the fundamental problems with the methods and approaches of nutritional sciences. <https://dgit.in/jan20-32>

There has been a decades long scientific flip flop on the benefits of eating meat

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For the purpose of this article, we will be ignoring the ethical and environmental considerations of

eating red meat. Even though it is important to understand the process after which food ends up on tables, here we will be focusing purely on the nutritional benefits of red meat consumption. Three kinds of meats will be discussed in this article. The red meat is made up of the muscle tissue from mammals, and includes everything from mutton to horse. Organ meat is particular organs from a mammalian body, such as kidney, brain or liver. Processed meat improves preservation or taste through a number of means including smoking, curing and salting. Processed meats can contain red meat, offal, poultry and other animal products such as blood. For the most part, chicken, fish, eggs and milk should not be considered in the same category.

The dietary guidelines of each country address the deficiencies typically seen in the diets of those countries. Since the 1980s, there has been an increasing number of studies pointing towards the pitfalls of consuming too much red meat and processed meat. The primary problem is cholesterol, which is found in abundance in mammalian bodies. The body synthesises the chemical on its own, so it is not a required part of the diet. An increase in cholesterol levels is linked with heart diseases.

THE PROBLEMS WITH MEAT

The Dietary Guidelines for Americans is issued every five years, and contains recommendations based on current

THE NUTRITIONAL VALUE OF MEAT



scientific understandings of nutrition. The latest guideline, published in 2016 recommends an increased focus on plant based food, and only the consumption of lean meats. Even the earliest guidelines from the 1980s, focused on reducing the consumption of food-stuff with cholesterol, and increasing the amount of fiber and starch intake, which is essentially from vegetables, fruits, grain, bread and nuts.

The Eatwell Guide from the United Kingdom, was last published in 2016. It recommends that more pulses be

consumed, while reducing the amount of red and processed meats. It also recommends having five meals a day, and increasing the intake of potatoes, a diet that seems to be particularly suitable for the inhabitants of Middle Earth.

In India, The National Institute of Nutrition has published a Dietary Guidelines for Indians, first in 1998 and a second edition in 2011. What it says about meat is pretty straightforward. Animal sources of protein have a variety of amino acids, and if not eating meat, then a combination of pulses,